

worry about ever going out of business. Here in America, we use our credit cards 52 million times a day. That's 36,242 times a minute that cards are being swiped. Shopping malls, grocery stores, restaurants, gas stations, fast food joints. Our credit cards see a lot of action. The credit card issuers get a percentage on every purchase. Over 36,000 purchases a minute should be bringing down a hefty income.

Also, for the record, I have no quarrel with credit card-issuing banks, charging a reasonable interest rate. That is part of the deal with credit cards. Charge some interest. Make a healthy profit. The banks and card issuers would make cushy incomes with that factor alone, but they are not satisfied with that, and they want more. They are out for – you know what I am going to say – *obscene profits*. I have but one word to say to them. Tough.

We can fire back. And you already know how. Pick up the phone.

Human Cannonballs

1. **Call all your credit card companies and ask that they lower your interest rate.**

The problem is not that you use your credit cards. The problem is that the banks and credit card companies are also using your credit cards! They did not steal them out of your wallet to make false purchases, but they sure are using them to their full advantage, to get you for every possible dollar in interest. How do you fire back? Negotiate a better interest rate!

Kathleen had a large balance on her credit card and an alarming 22% interest rate. With one quick and simple phone call, Kathleen got her rate lowered. The customer service representative was very pleasant and Kathleen said very politely: “Hello, I am looking at my credit card statement and I noticed that my interest rate is higher than it used to be. I know that when I got the card it had an introductory interest rate. Is there any way I can have that rate back?”

All you have to do is ask!

Repeat these words: “Can you lower my rate?” Those are the golden words to know. The credit card company lowered